Markdown Quick Reference Card

A concise syntax guide optimized for a single two-sided printout.

1. Headers & Layout

Element	Syntax Example	Rendered Look / Notes
Heading 1	`# Header 1`	Main document or page title
Heading 2	`## Header 2`	Major section heading
Heading 3	`### Header 3`	Sub-section heading
Heading 4-6	`#### H4 ##### H5 ###### H6`	Deeply nested sub-headings
Horizontal Rule	`--- or *** or ___`	Creates a horizontal divider line
Line Break	`End a line with two spaces and press Enter`	Forces a line break without a new paragraph

2. Text Emphasis

Element	Syntax Example	Rendered Look / Notes
Bold	`**text** or __text__`	**Bold text** (strong importance)
Italic	`*text* or _text_`	*Italic text* (emphasis)
Bold & Italic	`***text***`	***Bold and italicized text***
Strikethrough	`~~text~~`	~~Strikethrough text~~ (GFM extended)

3. Lists

Element	Syntax Example	Rendered Look / Notes

Unordered List	`- Item 1`
	`- Item 2`
	`  * Sub-item 2a`
		• Item 1
		• Item 2
		  • Sub-item 2a (Indent 2 or 4 spaces)

Ordered List	`1. First item` `2. Second item`	1. First item 2. Second item (Numbers don't have to be sequential)
Task List	`- [x] Completed task` `- [ ] Incomplete task`	[x] Completed task [ ] Incomplete task (GFM extended)

4. Links & Images

Element	Syntax Example	Rendered Look / Notes
Inline Link	`[Google](https://google.com)`	A hyperlink with custom descriptive text
Link with Title	`[Google](https://google.com "Find")`	Hovering displays the title tooltip
Anchor / ID Link	`[Section 1](#section-1)`	Links to an internal header anchor
Image Link	`![Alt Text](image.jpg)`	Embeds an image. Text shows if load fails
Linked Image	`[ ![Alt](img.jpg) ](url)`	Wraps an image inside an active clickable link

5. Blocks & Code

Element	Syntax Example	Rendered Look / Notes
Blockquote	`> This is a quote.` `> Multiple lines work.`	Indents and styles block quotes from other text
Nested Blockquote	`> Outer quote` `>> Inner nested quote`	Creates a blockquote within a blockquote
Inline Code	`` `code snippet` ``	Highlights a brief phrase or command inline

Code Block	```` ```javascript ````
	`const x = 5;`
	`console.log(x);`
	```` ``` ````
		Creates a multi-line code block with optional language syntax highlighting indicator

6. Tables

Element	Syntax Example	Rendered Look / Notes

Standard Table	`| Header 1 | Header 2 |`
	`| --- | --- |`
	`| Cell 1 | Cell 2 |`
		Creates columns and rows using pipe and dash notation

Alignment Rules	`| Left | Center | Right |`
	`| :--- | :---: | ---: |`
	`| Text | Text | Text |`
		Colons dictate text alignment within the column:
		• Left-aligned: :---
		• Centered: :---:
		• Right-aligned: ---:

7. Miscellaneous & Extended Syntax

Element	Syntax Example	Rendered Look / Notes

Footnotes	`Here is a note[^1].`
	
	`[^1]: The footnote text.`
		Creates a small superscript link to reference notes at the bottom of the document

Escaping Characters	`\*Not italic\*`	Uses a backslash to render literal markdown characters
Inline HTML	`<kbd>Ctrl</kbd>`	Allows direct raw HTML formatting blocks inside markdown for specific elements
Emoji Shortcuts	`:rocket: or :smile:`	Supported on platforms like GitHub, Slack, and Discord